

Microlife

There are billions of very tiny living things around us, on us, and even inside us! Our eyes can just about see some of this microlife. However, we need to use a microscope to see how amazing they really are.

Hair lice

These tiny insects live in hair, usually children's. They bite the scalp to feed on blood. However, apart from causing itching, they are not harmful.

Hair lice have two antennae, or feelers, on their heads.

Hair lice glue their eggs, called nits, to shafts of hair.

Tardigrades

Also called water bears, these little animals live in wet places, such as mud. They are super tough, can survive in space, and can go without food and water for more than 30 years!

Dust mites

These blobby creatures eat bits of dead skin found in house dust and mould. They're very hard to see because they're tiny and almost see-through.



Dust mites have many little hairs, called setae.



Tardigrades have four pairs of chunky legs with tiny claws. Their name means "slow stepper".